The Hygiene Trap

Questions for a fridge technician

People who service fridges open the panels and pull out the filters. They may have seen what is in there many times. This sheet is for asking them, politely. It is **not an accusation**: field experience is a lead, not proof, and it is a very good place to look. Write numbers where you can ("about 3 service calls in 10"), not impressions.

Date _____ Region (not a name) _____ Their role (technician, installer, plumber) _____ Years in the job _____

#	Ask	What they said (with numbers)
1	How often do you see slime or discolouration in a fridge's water lines or filter?	
2	How old are the filters when you see it, and how often do owners really change them?	
3	Do customers mention a taste or smell in the water or the ice? How often?	
4	What do you see on the spout, the paddle and the drip tray? Mould? How often?	
5	When you replace a filter, do you flush it? How? Do you sanitise the lines?	
6	Are some models or parts worse than others, and why?	
7	Where does the water tank and line sit in this model? Does it touch the food compartment?	
8	What would you tell an owner to do?	

Please leave out the names of people and companies. If you would like to share what you learn, summarise it as counts, without names, and add it to the project (github.com/aptitudetechnology/fridge-water).

Source: The Hygiene Trap, print pages. https://fridge-water.ownhealth.bio/fridge-water#handouts (whole site: https://fridge-water.ownhealth.bio/). Printed November 6, 2026.
Every claim carries a label: established, plausible, untested, anecdote or real. This is a hypothesis, not a diagnosis: for persistent bad breath or symptoms, see a dentist and a doctor.
Text: CC BY 4.0. Please credit the Fridge water project, https://github.com/aptitudetechnology/fridge-water.